Temporary Graduate visa (subclass 485)

Post-Vocational Education Work stream

This visa is for international students who have recently graduated with an associate degree, diploma or trade qualification relevant to an occupation Australia needs. It allows you to live, study and work in Australia temporarily.

Step by step

Step 1

Before you apply

Begin these steps as soon as possible after your education provider has confirmed you have successfully completed your course.

Make sure you have a passport

You need a valid passport for this visa.

If you plan to get a new passport, do so before applying for your visa.

Check your visa conditions

If you have a current visa with a 'No further stay' condition 8534 or 8503 on your current visa, you can't apply for this visa online. Please submit an ImmiAccount technical support form *(/help-support/departmental-forms/online-forms/immiaccount-technical-support-form)*.

To see your conditions see VEVO *(/visas/already-have-a-visa/check-visa-details-and-conditions/)*.

Organise health exams

You may need health examinations.

Find out the examinations you need *(/help-support/meeting-our-requirements/health/what-health-examinations-you-need)* and how to arrange them. Arranging examinations before you apply may lead to a faster decision.

Ask a question

Get help with your application

Only some people can help you with your application. If you appoint someone to give you immigration assistance they must be:

- a registered migration agent *(/help-support/who-can-help-with-your-application/using-a-migration-agent)*
- a legal practitioner *(/help-support/who-can-help-with-your-application/using-a-legal-practitioner)*
- an exempt person *(/help-support/who-can-help-with-your-application/exempt-person)*.

You can appoint anyone to receive documents *(/help-support/who-can-help-with-your-application/authorised-recipents)* on your behalf relating to your visa matter.

Arrange a skills assessment

A relevant assessing authority must assess your skills as being suitable for your nominated occupation *(/visas/working-in-australia/skill-occupation-list)*.

Each authority assesses the skills against their individual professional standards.

Contact the relevant authority to find the requirements for your occupation

The relevant authority for your occupation can be found in the list of eligible skilled occupations *(/visas/working-in-australia/skill-occupation-list)*.

Organise your skills assessment with the relevant authority

You must provide your valid skills assessment with your application. If you don't have a skills assessment, you must provide evidence that you have applied for one.

Skills assessments are valid for a maximum of 3 years, unless a shorter date is specified on the assessment.

Step 2

Gather your documents

Provide proof of your study, qualifications, skills assessment, identity and relationships. You will also need to provide documents for your family members.

Provide accurate information

Provide accurate information. See what happens if you can't prove your identity or don't provide true information *(/help-support/meeting-our-requirements/providing-accurate-information)*.

Identity documents

Provide the pages of your current passport showing your photo, personal details, and passport issue and expiry dates.

Also provide:

- a national identity card, if you have one
- proof of change of name.

Documents that prove a change of name include:

- a marriage or divorce certificate
- change of name documents from an Australian Registry of Births, Deaths and Marriages, or the relevant overseas authority
- documents that show other names you have been known by.

Study documents

The documents you need for your application are listed under 'Evidence to attach to your application' on Meeting the Temporary Graduate visa study requirement *(/visas/getting-a-visa/visa-listing/temporary-graduate-485/meeting-the-temporary-graduate-visa-subclass-485-study-requirement)*.

English language requirement documents

To prove your English level meets the requirements, show us evidence that you are a citizen of and hold a v

- The United Kingdom
- The United States of America
- Canada
- New Zealand
- The Republic of Ireland.

In the 12 months immediately before the day you apply for your visa, you must have scored one of the spec

For tests taken on or after 7 August 2025, note the following changes:

- OET does not currently provide overall test results *(https://oet.com/test/test-overview/results-and-scoring)* on test sc
- The department accepts IELTS test results that include One Skill Retake (OSR) for a Temporary Graduate v
- The department accepts MET test results that include Single Section Retake (SSR) for a Temporary Gradua

For further information, see English Language visa requirements *(/help-support/meeting-our-requirements/english-lang*

Acceptable minimum scores – Test taken on or after 7 August 2025

Test Sub-skill	C1 Advanced	CELPIP General	IELTS Academic *(https://ielts.org/take-a-test/test-types/ielts-academic-test)*	IELTS General Training *(https://ielts.org/take-a-test/test-types/ielts-general-training-test)*	LANGUAGECERT Aca *(https://www.languagecert. exams/english/languagece academic/academic)*
Overall	Not accepted	8	6.5	6.5	67
Listening	Not accepted	6	5.5	5.5	49
Reading	Not accepted	6	5.5	5.5	54
Writing	Not accepted	6	5.5	5.5	56
Speaking	Not accepted	6	5.5	5.5	62

Acceptable minimum scores – Test taken on or before 6 August 2025

Test Sub-skill	CAE / C1 Advanced	IELTS
Overall	176	6.5
Listening	162	5.5
Reading	162	5.5
Writing	162	5.5
Speaking	162	5.5

Holders of British National (BNO) or Hong Kong passports must have scored one of the following in the 12 m

Acceptable minimum scores – Test taken on or after 7 August 2025 – Holders of British National (BNO) or

Test Sub-skill	C1 Advanced	CELPIP General *(https://www.celpip.ca/celpip-general/)*	IELTS Academic *(https://ielts.org/take-a-test/test-types/ielts-academic-test)*	IELTS General Training *(https://ielts.org/take-a-test/test-types/ielts-general-training-test)*	LANGUAGE *(https://www.la exams/english/ academic/acad*
Overall	Not accepted	7	6	6	61
Listening	Not accepted	5	5	5	41
Reading	Not accepted	5	5	5	44
Writing	Not accepted	5	5	5	45
Speaking	Not accepted	5	5	5	54

Acceptable minimum scores – Test taken on or before 6 August 2025 - Holders of British National (BNO) o

Test Sub-skill	CAE / C1 Advanced	IELTS
Overall	169	6
Listening	154	5
Reading	154	5
Writing	154	5
Speaking	154	5

Skills assessment documents

Provide evidence that the relevant assessment authority has assessed your skills as suitable for your nominated occupation.

Assessing authorities may require a higher level of study than what is required for the Post-Vocational Education Work (PVEW) stream. Ensure that your skills and qualifications match the requirements of your nominated occupation, as set by the relevant assessing authority.

If you have not received your skills assessment yet, you must provide evidence that you have applied to the relevant assessment authority to have your skills assessed.

You must attach the completed assessment in ImmiAccount *(https://online.immi.gov.au/lusc/login)*.

Health insurance documents

You must prove that you have adequate health insurance in Australia. Provide:

- a signed letter from your health insurance provider(s)
- a Medicare card or proof of your enrolment with Medicare
- evidence of health insurance.

Character documents

You and any other applicants aged 16 years or over must provide evidence that you applied for an Australian Federal Police (AFP) check within the 12 month period ending the day before you submit your visa application.

This means:

- you must not apply for the AFP check on the same day as your visa application
- you must apply for the AFP check no earlier than 12 months before and no later than the day before your visa application date.

We only accept complete disclosure National Police Certificates (Immigration/Citizenship – Australia Name Check Only) issued by the Australian Federal Police *(https://www.afp.gov.au/what-we-do/services/criminal-records/national-police-checks)*.

We do not accept:

- standard disclosure certificates
- national police certificates issued by Australian state or territory police, or
- certificates from any other organisation.

Note: the AFP National Police Checks system may take up to 24 hours to generate a receipt following submission. The AFP application submission confirmation page can be saved and used as evidence of the date you applied for the AFP check.

You must complete and provide:

- Form 80 Personal particulars for character assessment (596KB PDF) *(/form-listing/forms/80.pdf)*
- Form 1221 Additional personal particulars information (331KB PDF) *(/form-listing/forms/1221.pdf)*

If requested, you may also need to provide:

- an overseas police certificate from each country you have lived in for a total of 12 months or more in the last 10 years since turning 16, including your home country
- military service records or discharge papers if you served in the armed forces of any country

For more information, see character requirements for visas *(/help-support/meeting-our-requirements/character)*.

Tell us you are getting help

To nominate someone to:

- receive your correspondence, use Form 956A Appointment or withdrawal of an authorised recipient (301KB PDF) *(/form-listing/forms/956a.pdf)*
- provide immigration assistance, use Form 956 Appointment of a registered migration agent, legal practitioner or exempt person (308KB PDF) *(/form-listing/forms/956.pdf)*.

Upload your written notification or your forms to ImmiAccount *(/help-support/applying-online-or-on-paper/overview)*.

Partner documents

Provide your partner's:

- identity documents
- character documents
- documents about other family members, if applicable.

If you are married, provide your marriage certificate or other evidence that your marriage is valid in Australia.

If you are a de facto partner, provide proof of your de facto relationship.

Additional proof of a de facto relationships

In addition to documents proving your relationship, provide evidence that:

- you have been in your de facto relationship for at least 12 months before you applied for this visa, or
- if applicable, provide evidence that your relationship is registered by a participating Australian state or territory.

Dependants under 18 documents

For every dependant 18 years old or younger who is applying with you, provide:

- copies of birth certificates or the family book showing the names of both parents of all your dependent children
- copies of the adoption paper, if applicable.

Parental responsibility documents

You must get consent for any applicant under 18 years of age to migrate to Australia from anyone who:

- has a legal right to decide where the child lives and
- is not coming to Australia with the child.

They must complete either:

- Form 1229 Consent form to grant an Australian visa to a child under the age of 18 years (276KB PDF) *(/form-listing/forms/1229.pdf)*
- a statutory declaration giving their consent for the child to visit Australia on this visa.

Alternatively, you can show us:

- an Australian court order that allows your child to migrate to Australia, or
- that the laws of your home country allow them to migrate.

Include:

- an identity document that shows the signature and photo of the person who completed the form or declaration, such as a passport or driver's licence
- adoption papers or other court documents if applicable.

Dependants over 18 documents

To include your child who is over 18 in your visa application, they must be:

- over 18 years of age but not yet turned 23, and dependent on you or your partner, or
- over 23 years of age and unable to earn a living to support themselves due to physical or cognitive limitations and dependent on you or your partner.

If your child is likely to turn 23 while your application is being processed, you will need to provide evidence they are dependent on you due to disability.

Provide:

- identity documents

- documents about their other relationships, if applicable
- character documents.

You must also provide proof the child is dependent on you.

- proof of your relationship with the dependant such as a birth certificate or adoption papers
- a completed Form 47a Details of a child or other dependent family member aged 18 years or over (307KB PDF) *(/form-listing/forms/47a.pdf)*
- proof of financial dependency such as bank statements, money transfers and rent receipts
- if the child is aged 23 or is likely to turn 23 while your application is being processed, you must also provide a report from a qualified medical practitioner that states they are dependent on you or your partner due to the total or partial loss of their bodily or mental functions.

Prepare your documents

Translate

Have all non-English documents translated into English.

Provide original and translated documents in your application.

Translators in Australia must be accredited by the National Accreditation Authority for Translators and Interpreters *(https://www.naati.com.au/)*.

Translators outside Australia do not have to be accredited. But on each translation, they must include their:

- full name
- address and telephone number
- qualifications and experience in the language they are translating.

These details must be in English.

Note: You do not need to have any documents certified.

Scan or photograph

Scan or photograph all documents (English and non-English) in colour.

The scans and photos must be clear.

If a document is more than one page, save it all as one file.

Step 3

Apply for the visa

You must apply for this visa online.

If you are having problems lodging your application, see common issues and error messages *(/help-support/applying-online-or-on-paper/online/common-issues-and-error-messages)*.

Provide accurate information

Provide accurate information. See what happens if you can't prove your identity or don't provide true information. *(/help-support/meeting-our-requirements/providing-accurate-information)*

Apply online

1. Create an account or log in to ImmiAccount *(/help-support/applying-online-or-on-paper/online)*
2. Attach documents *(/help-support/applying-online-or-on-paper/online#content-index-2)*
3. Have family applications processed together. Each family member must still have their Visa Application Charge paid and documents attached to their application
4. Pay the Visa Application Charge *(/help-support/applying-online-or-on-paper/online/how-to-pay)*. We will not process your application until you pay the charge.

When you submit your application you must pay for you and your family members or your application will not be valid.

Note:

- Choose visa stream carefully - it is not possible to make changes after you apply.
- A valid application must be made within the eligibility timeframe. Late applications cannot be accepted.
- Applications are received Australian Eastern Standard Time (AEST) (or Australian Eastern daylight standard time (AEDST) when applicable).

When you submit your application you must attach the following information:

- evidence of successful course completion
- evidence of the required level of English
- evidence all applicants over the age of 16 years have applied for an Australian Federal Police check. See character requirements for visas *(/help-support/meeting-our-requirements/character)*
- evidence of adequate health insurance for all applicants
- evidence you have applied for a skills assessment in your nominated occupation on the skilled occupation list *(/visas/working-in-australia/skill-occupation-list)*.

If you have a technical problem with your ImmiAccount or online application see how to resolve error messages when submitting online *(/help-support/applying-online-or-on-paper/online/common-issues-and-error-*

messages).

Step 4

After you apply

We will let you know when we have received your application and documents. See what you can and must do after you apply.

Status updates

We cannot give status updates while your application is within standard processing timeframes.

For any information requests, check ImmiAccount *(/help-support/applying-online-or-on-paper/online)* .

Travel after you apply

You can be in or outside Australia (but not in immigration clearance) when we decide on your visa application.

Health exams

Find out the examinations you need *(/help-support/meeting-our-requirements/health/what-health-examinations-you-need)* and how you can arrange them. Arranging examinations before you apply may lead to a faster decision.

Attach more information

You can attach further supporting documents in ImmiAccount *(/help-support/applying-online-or-on-paper/online)*.

You should provide any requested information within the specified timeframe. We can make a decision on your application once the timeframe has passed.

Stay lawful

Make sure you stay lawful by holding a valid visa while we process your application.

When you applied for this visa, you were granted a bridging visa. If your current visa expires before we decide on your application, your bridging visa will allow you to stay lawfully in Australia while we process your application.

Do not cancel your current visa. If you do, you will be staying in Australia unlawfully.

Learn more about visa expiry *(/visas/visa-about-to-expire)*.

Add family

You may be able to add your dependent child to your application for this visa before we make a decision.

You will need to:

- complete Form 1436 Adding an additional applicant after lodgement (481KB PDF) *(/form-listing/forms/1436.pdf)* with a clear statement to add the child to your 485 application
- attach all supporting documents including the child's passport, birth certificate and documents to prove your relationship and custody.

Your family can also apply to join you in Australia as a subsequent entrant after the visa is granted. See when you have this visa *(/visas/getting-a-visa/visa-listing/temporary-graduate-485/graduate-work#When)*.

Newborn children

If your child is born after you apply but before we make a decision on your visa, then your child is considered to have made the same visa application as you.

You must tell us as soon as possible and give us:

- a copy of the child's birth certificate
- a completed Form 1022 Notification of changes in circumstances (172KB PDF) *(/form-listing/forms/1022.pdf)*
- copies of all supporting documents including the child's passport if available.

Mistakes on your application

Let us know as soon as you can.

Complete Form 1023 Notification of incorrect answers (168KB PDF) *(/form-listing/forms/1023.pdf)*

Help with your application

Let us know if you no longer want someone to:

- receive your correspondence - complete Form 956A Appointment or withdrawal of an authorised recipient (301KB PDF) *(/form-listing/forms/956a.pdf)*
- provide immigration advice - complete Form 956 Appointment of a registered migration agent, legal practitioner or exempt person (308KB PDF) *(/form-listing/forms/956.pdf)*.

Upload your written notification or your forms to ImmiAccount *(/help-support/applying-online-or-on-paper/overview)*.

For more information see Who can help you with your application *(/help-support/who-can-help-with-your-application/overview)*.

Tell us if things change

Things you need to let us know about include:

- changes to the your phone number, email, address or passport
- changes to the your relationship status
- the birth of a child
- you want to withdraw your application.

See how to tell us if your situation changes *(/change-in-situation)*.

Step 5

Visa outcome

You can be in or outside Australia (but not in immigration clearance) when we decide on your visa application.

If you are a subsequent entrant (family member), you can be in or outside Australia when we decide on your visa application.

If your visa application is approved

If we grant your visa, we will tell you:

- your visa grant number
- your visa grant date
- your visa conditions.

Keep a copy of the email with you when in Australia.

If your visa application is refused

If we refuse your visa we will let you know by email. We will tell you why we refused and whether you have a right to a review of the decision.

We will not refund the Visa Application Charge if we refuse your application.

Last updated:
12 October 2026